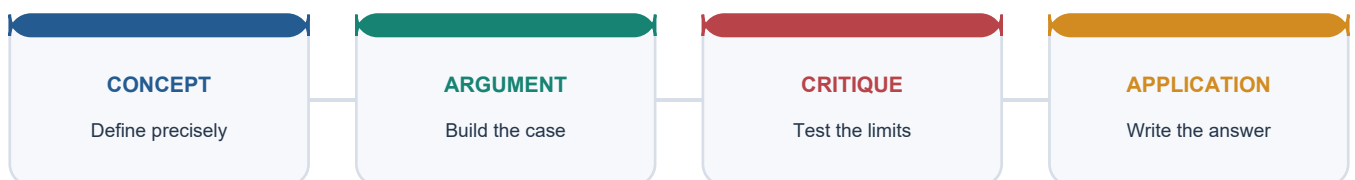


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Interdisciplinary Political Analysis - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Interdisciplinary Political Analysis - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 09 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Discipline**?

- A. A branch or field of learning.
- B. political order does not require a Weberian state.
- C. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.
- D. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal. (PDF pp.144-145)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Discipline.
- **B:** B Attaches to Political anthropology, not Discipline.
- **C:** C Attaches to Normative approach, not Discipline.
- **D:** D Attaches to Psychology, not Discipline.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Discipline by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Interdisciplinary approach**?

- A. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.
- B. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
- C. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.
- D. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Political sociology, not Interdisciplinary approach.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Interdisciplinary approach.
- **C:** C Attaches to Auguste Comte, not Interdisciplinary approach.
- **D:** D Attaches to Political economy, not Interdisciplinary approach.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Interdisciplinary approach by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Empirical approach**?

- A. Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.
- B. Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.
- C. Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
- D. Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Philosophy, not Empirical approach.
- **B:** B Attaches to Sociology, not Empirical approach.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Empirical approach.
- **D:** D Attaches to Economics, not Empirical approach.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Empirical approach by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Normative approach**?

- A. Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.
- B. political order does not require a Weberian state.
- C. Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.
- D. Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Psychology, not Normative approach.
- **B:** B Attaches to Political anthropology, not Normative approach.

- **C:** C Attaches to History, not Normative approach.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Normative approach.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Normative approach by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Political economy**?

- A. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.
- B. the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.
- C. political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.
- D. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Political economy.
- **B:** B Attaches to Aristotle, not Political economy.
- **C:** C Attaches to Seymour Martin Lipset, not Political economy.
- **D:** D Attaches to Auguste Comte, not Political economy.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Political economy by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Political sociology**?

- A. Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
- B. Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.
- C. science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.
- D. Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Interdisciplinary approach, not Political sociology.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Political sociology.
- **C:** C Attaches to Auguste Comte, not Political sociology.
- **D:** D Attaches to Political economy, not Political sociology.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Political sociology by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Political psychology**?

- A. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.
- B. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.
- C. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.
- D. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Heinz Eulau, not Political psychology.
- **B:** B Attaches to Political philosophy, not Political psychology.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Political psychology.
- **D:** D Attaches to Political geography, not Political psychology.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Political psychology by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Political philosophy**?

- A. Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.
- B. studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.
- C. political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.
- D. Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Political psychology, not Political philosophy.
- **B:** B Attaches to Political geography, not Political philosophy.
- **C:** C Attaches to Heinz Eulau, not Political philosophy.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Political philosophy.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Political philosophy by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. History - Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.
- B. Psychology - Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.
- C. Philosophy - Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.
- D. Normative approach - Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Faithful pairing: History is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Psychology is recorded with Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Philosophy is recorded with Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Normative approach is recorded with Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to History; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Philosophy - Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.
- B. Economics - Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.
- C. Empirical approach - Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.
- D. Sociology - Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Source disagrees: Philosophy is recorded with Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.
- **B:** B Kept where the source puts it: Economics is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Empirical approach is recorded with Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Sociology is recorded with Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Economics; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Empirical approach - Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.
- B. Economics - Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.
- C. Sociology - Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.
- D. Philosophy - Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Empirical approach is recorded with Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
- **B:** B Belongs elsewhere: Economics is recorded with Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.
- **C:** C Kept where the source puts it: Sociology is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: Philosophy is recorded with Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Sociology; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. Philosophy - political order does not require a Weberian state.
- B. History - Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.
- C. Normative approach - Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.
- D. Psychology - Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Philosophy is recorded with Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: History is recorded with Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Normative approach is recorded with Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.
- **D:** D Matches the record: Psychology is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Psychology; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. Philosophy - Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.
- B. Economics - Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.
- C. Sociology - Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.
- D. Empirical approach - Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Correct attachment: Philosophy is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Economics is recorded with Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: Sociology is recorded with Group life, institutions, status, attitudes, participation and political culture.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Empirical approach is recorded with Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Philosophy; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Normative approach - A branch or field of learning.
- B. Political anthropology - political order does not require a Weberian state.
- C. Psychology - Conceptual clarification, values, moral foundations and ends of public life.
- D. History - Insight into production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and economic conflict.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Normative approach is recorded with Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.
- **B:** B Exact pair: Political anthropology is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Wrong attachment: Psychology is recorded with Motives, attitudes, personality, propaganda and leadership appeal.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: History is recorded with Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Political anthropology; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model - (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy.
- B. David Easton's political-system framework - Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda. (PDF p.145)
- C. Law/jurisprudence as a data source - distinct from the legal approach to studying politics (already covered under Section 8's traditional approaches).
- D. Marx and Engels - political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model is recorded with is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: David Easton's political-system framework is recorded with is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback.
- **C:** C Source-exact: Law/jurisprudence as a data source is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Misplaced: Marx and Engels is recorded with Gauba credits them with an early systematic interdisciplinary approach by locating political behaviour in socio-economic factors such as production and class structure.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Law/jurisprudence as a data source; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Heinz Eulau - political development cannot be studied without social mobilization, value change, kinship patterns, caste and class relations.
- B. Political philosophy - the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.
- C. Political psychology - Analysis of political aspects of economic policy-making and of the mutual impact of economic forces and political decisions.
- D. Political geography - studies the spatial dimension of politics - territory, boundaries, resource distribution, federalism and regional/electoral geography.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Heinz Eulau is recorded with political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.
- **B:** B Source disagrees: Political philosophy is recorded with Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Political psychology is recorded with Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: Political geography is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Political geography; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Aristotle** is associated with: the classical approach treated politics as the "master science" and did not clearly separate normative from empirical analysis.
2. **Seymour Martin Lipset** is associated with: (treating all politics as market bargaining or class interest) misses legitimacy, identity and normative claims that are not reducible to material interest.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Aristotle does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Marx and Engels** is associated with: science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.
2. **Auguste Comte** is associated with: science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Marx and Engels does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Heinz Eulau** is associated with: political behaviour analysis must be interdisciplinary because political action occurs in a wider social, cultural and personal context.
2. **David Easton's political-system framework** is associated with: is itself a borrowed model - Gauba notes it imports the "system" concept from sociology/general systems theory into political science, treating politics as inputs-conversion-outputs-feedback .

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Heinz Eulau does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Seymour Martin Lipset** is associated with: is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.
2. **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model** is associated with: Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Seymour Martin Lipset does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **Auguste Comte** is associated with: science itself is rooted in philosophy; Gauba uses Comte to question any rigid opposition between science and philosophy.
2. **Economic reductionism** is associated with: Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Auguste Comte does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **David Easton's political-system framework** is associated with: A branch or field of learning.
2. **Discipline** is associated with: A branch or field of learning.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with David Easton's political-system framework does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model** is associated with: is cited by Gauba as an example of psychology and decision-theory feeding directly into political analysis, reframing political inquiry around identifying problems, generating alternatives and evaluating outcomes.
2. **Interdisciplinary approach** is associated with: Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Harold Lasswell's problem-solving model does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **Economic reductionism** is associated with: Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
2. **Empirical approach** is associated with: Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Economic reductionism does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Interdisciplinary study means political science has lost its identity."**?

- A. Gauba says political science remains focused on politics while using other disciplines for broader and better-grounded analysis. (PDF pp.137, 146)
- B. Interdisciplinary approach means Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
- C. The chapter concludes that philosophical, historical, legal, economic, sociological and psychological approaches are partial when used alone. (PDF p.146)
- D. Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says political science remains focused on politics while using other disciplines for broader and better-grounded analysis. (PDF pp.137, 146).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Interdisciplinary approach means Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "'One discipline can fully explain politics.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "'Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Interdisciplinary study means political science has, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant."**?

- A. Gauba says political science remains focused on politics while using other disciplines for broader and better-grounded analysis. (PDF pp.137, 146)
- B. Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)
- C. Interdisciplinary approach means Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
- D. Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used selectively and critically. (PDF p.141)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Interdisciplinary study means political science has lost its identity.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Interdisciplinary approach means Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "History and political science are the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "Empirical political science made philosophy, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"History and political science are the same thing."**?

- A. Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)
- B. Empirical approach means Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
- C. Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used selectively and critically. (PDF p.141)
- D. Normative approach means Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done; this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Empirical approach means Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used selectively and critically. (PDF p.141).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Normative approach means Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "History and political science are the same thing.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **"One discipline can fully explain politics."**?

- A. Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)
- B. Interdisciplinary approach means Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
- C. Gauba says political science remains focused on politics while using other disciplines for broader and better-grounded analysis. (PDF pp.137, 146)
- D. The chapter concludes that philosophical, historical, legal, economic, sociological and psychological approaches are partial when used alone. (PDF p.146)

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Interdisciplinary approach means Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "Interdisciplinary study means political science has lost its identity.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: The chapter concludes that philosophical, historical, legal, economic, sociological and psychological approaches are partial when used alone. (PDF p.146).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about "One discipline can fully explain politics.", not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Discipline means Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.?**

- A. Discipline means A branch or field of learning.
- B. Normative approach means Focus on values.
- C. Empirical approach means Focus on observable facts, explanation.
- D. Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Discipline means A branch or field of learning.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Normative approach means Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Empirical approach means Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "History and political science are the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Discipline means Study of political institutions,, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Interdisciplinary approach means Use of psychological models and techniques to analyse political behaviour, attitudes, learning, socialization, leadership and propaganda.**?

- A. Gauba says political science remains focused on politics while using other disciplines for broader and better-grounded analysis. (PDF pp.137, 146)
- B. Interdisciplinary approach means Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
- C. The chapter concludes that philosophical, historical, legal, economic, sociological and psychological approaches are partial when used alone. (PDF p.146)
- D. Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "Interdisciplinary study means political science has lost its identity.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Interdisciplinary approach means Use of more than one discipline to study a problem, especially where common or overlapping phenomena are involved.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "One discipline can fully explain politics.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, "Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Interdisciplinary approach means Use of, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Empirical approach means Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.**?

- A. Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used selectively and critically. (PDF p.141)
- B. Gauba says political philosophy regained prominence after post-behaviouralism and still helps define policy goals. (PDF pp.145-146)
- C. Empirical approach means Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
- D. Normative approach means Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, "History and political science are the same thing.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, "Empirical political science made philosophy irrelevant.", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Empirical approach means Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Normative approach means Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Empirical approach means Inquiry into moral and, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Normative approach means Verification through past events, sequences and long-term causation.**?

- A. Discipline means A branch or field of learning; this formulation is presented as sufficient for the classification.
- B. Empirical approach means Focus on observable facts, explanation, correlation, generalization and prediction.
- C. Gauba treats this older formula as an oversimplification; history is used selectively and critically. (PDF.
- D. Normative approach means Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Discipline means Study of political institutions, processes and ideologies in relation to social structures and modes of thought.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Empirical approach means Inquiry into moral and substantive dimensions of politics, including values, obligation, good life and the worth of political systems.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, "'History and political science are the same thing.'", so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Normative approach means Focus on values, prescriptions and what ought to be done.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Normative approach means Verification through past, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Interdisciplinary Political Analysis** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Define interdisciplinary political analysis and explain why borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of interdisciplinary political analysis and explain why borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Interdisciplinary, Core and Politics, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that random accumulation of neighbouring knowledge produces diffusion rather than integration.

Model answer (144 words):

Introduction: Interdisciplinary political analysis uses evidence, concepts or models from more than one discipline to investigate overlapping social phenomena. Core analysis: Politics is embedded in economic, social, historical, psychological, legal and spatial environments. Political science therefore borrows when another discipline supplies evidence needed to explain a political question. History tests sequences, economics identifies material interests, sociology maps groups, psychology examines attitudes, and philosophy evaluates ends. Gauba's qualification is essential: labour relations, kinship or crowd behaviour enter political analysis only insofar as they illuminate power, authority, conflict, legitimacy or policy. Borrowing is purposeful when the political problem determines what is selected and how it is interpreted. Interdisciplinarity should widen verification and causal depth while keeping political judgment

as the organising task. Conclusion: Interdisciplinarity deepens political explanation only when borrowed evidence answers a clearly political question; random accumulation of neighbouring knowledge produces diffusion rather than integration.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Interdisciplinary, Core and Politics), converts that evidence into analysis of interdisciplinary political analysis and explain why borrowing must remain purposeful and politics-centred, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that random accumulation of neighbouring knowledge produces diffusion rather than integration. At 144 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Explain how history and economics contribute differently to political analysis. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *explain* requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of how history and economics contribute differently to political analysis in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, History, Core and Economics, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that neither can independently settle legitimacy or justice.

Model answer (135 words):

Introduction: History and economics enrich political inquiry through different types of evidence and explanation. Core analysis: History supplies sequences, antecedents, comparisons and long-term patterns. It tests whether claims about democracy, state formation or conflict survive variation across time and cases, but becomes mere chronicle if events are not politically interpreted. Economics examines production, distribution, exchange, scarcity and incentives. Political economy uses these mechanisms to explain class conflict, welfare choices, public control and how economic demands shape state decisions. It exposes material constraints that formal institutional analysis may overlook. Critical evaluation: Neither discipline is sufficient alone. Political analysis must interpret historical evidence and economic mechanisms through institutions, power relations and normative standards. Conclusion: History tests political claims across time and sequence, while economics explains material incentives and distributional conflict; neither can independently settle legitimacy or justice.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *explain* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, History, Core and Economics), converts that evidence into analysis of how history and economics contribute differently to political analysis, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that neither can independently settle legitimacy or justice. At 135 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Can political science be studied independently of the other social sciences? Discuss. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *can* requires the answer to state the conditions under which the claim holds and where they fail. Fix the boundary of political science be studied independently of the other social sciences? Discuss in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, History and Behavioural, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Political science retains an autonomous organising question about power and authoritative allocation, but credible answers require evidence and models from the wider social sciences.

Model answer (141 words):

Introduction: Political science has a distinct organising concern with power, authority, conflict and binding collective decisions, but its subject matter cannot be isolated from wider social life. Core analysis: Gauba identifies three interdisciplinary functions: political science uses findings from related disciplines, verifies its theories through their evidence and contributes political insight back to them. History supplies temporal testing; economics explains resources and incentives; sociology identifies groups and institutions; psychology studies attitudes and leadership; philosophy clarifies values and ends. Behavioural and systems approaches intensified this exchange by shifting attention from formal government to actors and to the political system's environment. The defensible position is autonomy through integration: a distinct political focus supported by multiple bodies of evidence. Conclusion: Political science retains an autonomous organising question about power and authoritative allocation, but credible answers require evidence and models from the wider social sciences.

Why this earns marks: it obeys can instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, History and Behavioural), converts that evidence into analysis of political science be studied independently of the other social sciences? Discuss, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Political science retains an autonomous organising question about power and authoritative allocation, but credible answers require evidence and models from the wider social sciences. At 141 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Examine the contributions and limits of sociology and psychology in political analysis. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive examine requires the answer to test the proposition rather than describe it, weighing what supports and what weakens it. Fix the boundary of the contributions and limits of sociology and psychology in political analysis in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Sociology, Core and Eulau's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Sociology and psychology reveal social structure and individual motivation respectively, but political explanation requires both levels to be connected to institutions, resources and normative judgment.

Model answer (243 words):

Introduction: Sociology and psychology correct institutional accounts by explaining the social structures and individual processes through which politics is lived. Core analysis: Political sociology studies groups, status, norms, participation, leadership, political culture and the relation between social structures and political institutions. It explains why similar constitutional forms may operate differently across societies. Political psychology studies attitudes, learning, personality, propaganda, public opinion and charismatic or extremist appeal. It helps reconstruct how citizens and leaders perceive choices and acquire political orientations. Eulau's contextual account and Lipset's emphasis on mobilisation, values, kinship and class illustrate why behaviour cannot be detached from its environment. Further development: Their explanatory levels can be connected through mechanisms. Social structures influence the identities, incentives and information available to actors; psychological processes shape how those conditions are perceived and acted upon; institutions then aggregate or constrain the resulting conduct. This sequence avoids simply listing variables. It also shows why neither approach can establish the legitimacy of an outcome: evaluation of domination, justice or responsibility requires political philosophy in addition to causal explanation. Critical evaluation: Sociological reductionism may turn politics into passive maintenance of social structure, underplaying agency and deliberate institutional change. Psychological reductionism may individualise outcomes produced by class, law or organisation. The two disciplines contribute most when linked to each other and to political institutions. Conclusion: Sociology and psychology reveal social structure and individual motivation respectively, but political explanation requires both levels to be connected to institutions, resources and normative judgment.

Why this earns marks: it obeys examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Sociology, Core and Eulau's), converts that evidence into analysis of the contributions and limits of sociology and psychology in political analysis, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Sociology and psychology reveal social structure and individual motivation respectively, but political explanation requires both levels to be connected to institutions, resources and normative judgment. At 243 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate the interdisciplinary approach to political analysis with reference to major disciplines and borrowed models. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of the interdisciplinary approach to political analysis with reference to major disciplines and borrowed models in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Interdisciplinary, Core and History, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Interdisciplinary analysis is strongest as structured integration: multiple disciplines correct one another's blind spots while the political problem remains the organising centre.

Model answer (223 words):

Introduction: Interdisciplinary political analysis responds to the fact that political action occurs within overlapping historical, economic, social, psychological and normative environments. Core analysis: History verifies claims through sequences and cases; economics reveals scarcity, production and distribution; sociology explains groups, norms and participation; psychology studies attitudes, learning and leadership; philosophy clarifies obligation, justice and policy ends. Anthropology tests state-centred assumptions through non-state authority, law supplies formal texts and judicial reasoning, and geography reveals the territorial distribution of power and resources. Political science also borrows models: Easton's system comes from general systems thinking, structural-functionalism from sociology and anthropology, Lasswell's problem-solving orientation from psychology and decision theory, and base-superstructure analysis from political economy. Further development: A full evaluation must distinguish data from models and explanation from evaluation. Literacy, income, kinship, attitudes, legal rules and regional distribution are data drawn from different disciplines; systems, structural-functional, market, elite and problem-solving frameworks organise causal interpretation. Philosophy then asks whether the resulting institutions and policies are justified. The approach is not automatically superior merely because it contains more variables. Explanations become incoherent when causal levels are mixed or evidence is imported without relevance. Gauba's remedy is integrated verification without merger and purposeful retention of the political question. Conclusion: Interdisciplinary analysis is strongest as structured integration: multiple disciplines correct one another's blind spots while the political problem remains the organising centre.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Interdisciplinary, Core and History), converts that evidence into analysis of the interdisciplinary approach to political analysis with reference to major disciplines and borrowed models, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Interdisciplinary analysis is strongest as structured integration: multiple disciplines correct one another's blind spots while the political problem remains the organising centre. At 223 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Does interdisciplinarity deepen or threaten the autonomy of political science? Critically discuss. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *discuss* requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of interdisciplinarity deepen or threaten the autonomy of political science? Critically discuss in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Interdisciplinarity, Core and History, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that yet political science asks a question none of them settles alone: how power, authority and conflict produce collectively binding decisions and how those decisions should be judged.

Model answer (250 words):

Introduction: Interdisciplinarity appears to threaten autonomy because political science borrows much of its evidence and many models from neighbouring disciplines. Core analysis: The threat is real when economics reduces politics to bargaining or class, psychology to personality, sociology to system maintenance, law to formal rules, or geography to spatial destiny. A discipline that merely aggregates these accounts loses a distinct explanatory task. Yet political science asks a question none of them settles alone: how power, authority and conflict produce collectively binding decisions and how those decisions should be judged. History, economics, sociology, psychology, philosophy, anthropology, law and geography then become evidence routes organised around that problem. Borrowed models such as Easton's system or Lasswell's problem-solving framework remain political when adapted to political actors, institutions and consequences. Further development: The Indian application can remain conceptual. Analysis of democratic durability may combine historical institution-building, economic inequality, caste or community structures, mass attitudes, constitutional law and territorial diversity. The 29 June 2026 release of MoSPI's SDG National Indicator Framework Progress Report offers a current evidence anchor because it organises time-series indicators across all seventeen SDGs for monitoring and policy. Such a framework illustrates interdisciplinary evidence, not a self-interpreting political conclusion. Indicator selection, distributional priorities, accountability and the meaning of development still require political and philosophical judgment. Purposeful integration deepens political science; uncritical merger or single-discipline reduction threatens it. Conclusion: Interdisciplinarity deepens rather than dissolves political science when borrowing is selective, reductionism is resisted and the discipline retains responsibility for political explanation and evaluation.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *discuss* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Interdisciplinarity, Core and History), converts that evidence into analysis of interdisciplinarity deepen or threaten the autonomy of political science? Critically discuss, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that yet political science asks a question none of them settles alone: how power, authority and conflict produce collectively binding decisions and how those decisions should be judged. At 250 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
